

Annex Five

Answers to ETAT assessment questions

Assessment questions: Triage

1. Define "triage".

The sentence should read: Triage is the **sorting** of patients into **priority** groups according to their **needs** and the **resources** available. (See page 3)

2. When and where should triage take place?

This assessment will decide whether the patient needs to be seen immediately and receive any life-saving treatment, or be seen soon as a priority, or can safely wait in the queue until his/her turn. (See page 3). It can be done in the OPD, emergency room or in the wards.

3. Who should do triaging?

A person who is trained to assess the seriousness of sick children should see all of them **on their arrival** in hospital.

4. What do the letters A, B, C and D in "ABCD" stand for?

The letters A, B, C and D (see page 4) stand for:

- A** Airway
- B** Breathing
- C** Circulation, Coma and Convulsions
- D** Diarrhoea and Dehydration

5. List the priority signs:

The following are priority signs (see page 4):

- Tiny baby (any sick child is under 2 months of age)
- Temperature: child is very hot
- Trauma
- Pallor (severe)
- Poisoning
- Pain (severe)
- Respiratory distress
- Restless, continuously irritable or lethargic
- Referral (urgent)
- Malnutrition (visible severe wasting)
- Oedema of both feet
- Burns

6. Put the actions in the right chronological order: what will you do first, what next, what after that, and so on, and what last?

Actions are given in the correct chronological order on the right:

2	Ask about head or neck trauma
4	Call a senior health worker to see any emergency
5	Have blood specimens taken for laboratory analysis
6	Look for any priority signs
1	Look for emergency signs
8	Move on to the next patient
7	Place priority patients at the front of the queue
3	Start treatment of any emergency signs you find

7. A three-year old girl is carried in her mother's arms wrapped in a blanket, in the queue. Her airway and breathing are OK. She has cold hands. Her capillary refill is 1.5 seconds. She is alert. Asked if the child has had diarrhoea, the mother answered "YES. Four loose stools per day". The skin pinch takes 3 seconds. How do you triage this child?

Assessment is made following ABCD. The steps ABCD for emergency signs are normal. Now the child can be assessed for "P" priority signs.

8. A four-year old male child was rushed in. He convulsed one hour ago. He is breathing fast but there is no cyanosis and no respiratory distress. He feels very hot, but responds quickly to questions. He has no diarrhoea or vomiting. How do you triage this child?

Again, following the ABCD steps, the child does not have "E" emergency signs so the next step is to look for priority signs. On assessment of priority signs, the child is very hot, so the child is given priority for a full assessment.

9. A one-year old had a seizure at home; then again outside the clinic. He became unconscious. His breathing sounds very wet and noisy and there is drooling coming from his mouth. He is looking blue. How do you triage this child?

The assessment follows the ABCD steps. First assess the airway, this child is drooling and may have obstructed breathing and is cyanosed. He therefore has emergency signs in under “A” and should be sent to the emergency room.

10. A two-year old male is rushed to your clinic acutely convulsing. How do you triage this child?

The assessment follows the ABCD steps. First assess the airway, breathing, and circulation, no positive signs are provided here. The child is convulsing and has emergency signs in under “C” and should be sent to the emergency room.

11. What signs of malnutrition do you check during triage?

You check for visible severe wasting and oedema of both feet.

12. Where do you look for signs of severe wasting?

Signs of severe wasting are best visible on the **chest, arms, thighs and buttocks**; the skin looks too large for the body.

13. Below what age is a child always a priority?

A child below the age of **two months** is always a priority.

14. What should you do if the child has a priority sign?

When children are found to have a priority sign you will **put them to the front of the queue so that they will be seen as soon as possible**.